

SERIES DOSSIER: GHOST RACERS

Phase 6 · Disney+ Series #1 (Saga Two, Series #5)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Series #	Phase 6, Series #1 (limit: 2 this phase)
Phase	Phase 6, The Secret Wars Saga : "Secret Wars"
Real title	<i>GHOST RACERS</i> (the name of the 616 Secret Wars tie-in)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"PIT STOP"</i>
Premiere	Tuesday, October 3, 2028
Finale	Tuesday, November 21, 2028. Episode 5 airs on Halloween (Tuesday, October 31)
Episodes	8 (one a week, Tuesdays)
Episode runtime	44–52 minutes
Platform	Disney+ (Tuesday premieres)
Showrunner	Gareth Evans (director of World War Hulk), with Felipe Smith (co-creator of Robbie Reyes and writer of <i>Ghost Racers</i>) as consulting producer
Rating	TV-MA, under the R-rated street-level label, the MCU's first supernatural series on it
Genre + second genre	Supernatural action + gladiator sports drama / demon road racing

Episode schedule

Ep	Title	Airdate
1	"The Killiseum"	Tue, October 3, 2028
2	"Robbie"	Tue, October 10, 2028
3	"Johnny Blaze"	Tue, October 17, 2028
4	"Spirits of Vengeance"	Tue, October 24, 2028
5	"Hellfire Night"	Tue, October 31, 2028
6	"Murderworld"	Tue, November 7, 2028
7	"Zarathos"	Tue, November 14, 2028
8	"Last Lap"	Tue, November 21, 2028

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose series / franchise is this?	GABRIEL LUNA , the only real actor to have played Robbie Reyes (<i>Agents of S.H.I.E.L.D.</i> , 2016). Nicolas Cage , the most iconic real Ghost Rider, co-leads as Johnny Blaze .

Character	Actor	Age at premiere
Robbie Reyes / Ghost Rider (<i>the champion</i>)	Gabriel Luna	45
Johnny Blaze / Ghost Rider (<i>the veteran</i>)	Nicolas Cage (<i>played Johnny Blaze in Ghost Rider, 2007 and 2012</i>)	64
Danny Ketch / Ghost Rider	Fresh casting	—
Alejandra Jones / Ghost Rider	Fresh casting	—
Carter Slade / the Phantom Rider (<i>the Old West rider</i>)	Fresh casting	—
Gabe Reyes (<i>Robbie's younger brother</i>)	Lorenzo James Henrie (<i>played Gabe in Agents of S.H.I.E.L.D.</i>)	—
Arcade (<i>master of the Killiseum</i>)	Fresh casting (<i>never played by a real actor</i>)	—
God Doom (<i>a voice from the royal box</i>)	Robert Downey Jr.	63

Casting note: on 616, Robbie Reyes is a teenager (2014). Gabriel Luna is the only real actor to have played him, so per the Casting Rules he keeps the role, and Battleworld's Robbie is written in his thirties. Same precedent as Shameik Moore's Miles.

In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018). In Episode 1, the Killiseum announcer calls the crowd to its feet with "Face front, true believers!", and the whole arena answers "Excelsior!"**

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Ghost Racers #1–4 (2015), Felipe Smith & Juan Gedeon, the Secret Wars tie-in: on Battleworld, every Ghost Rider (Robbie Reyes, Johnny Blaze, Danny Ketch, Alejandra Jones, Carter Slade) is forced to race to the death in the Killiseum, run by Arcade, as entertainment for Doom's Battleworld. Robbie is the crowd's champion. The racers rise up.
Supporting comics	Marvel Spotlight #5 (1972), Gary Friedrich, Roy Thomas & Mike Ploog: Johnny Blaze sells his soul to save his father figure, and becomes the Ghost Rider · All-New Ghost Rider #1–12 (2014–15), Felipe Smith & Tradd Moore: Robbie Reyes, the Hell Charger, his brother Gabe · <i>Ghost Rider</i> vol. 2 #1 (1990, Danny Ketch) · <i>Ghost Rider</i> vol. 6 (2010, Alejandra) · <i>Ghost Rider</i> #1 (1967, Carter Slade) · <i>X-Men</i> #123 (1979, Arcade and Murderworld)
Nerf check	 The Ghost Riders are among the most powerful supernatural beings on Earth: hellfire, the Penance Stare, supernatural strength, near-invulnerability. Nobody on the track is held back. Zarathos, the demon inside Johnny, is terrifying.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	94% . <i>Ghost Racers</i> is adapted closely, with the origins of Robbie and Johnny told in flashback.

Straight from the page:

- All the Ghost Riders race for their lives in the Killiseum (#1).
- Arcade runs the Killiseum for Battleworld's entertainment (#1).
- Robbie Reyes, in his Charger, is the crowd's favorite (#1).
- Johnny Blaze, the veteran on his bike, and Danny Ketch (#1–4).
- Carter Slade, the Western rider, on his phantom horse (#1–4).
- The racers rise up against Arcade (#3–4).

Flashback origins (straight from the page):

- Johnny Blaze sells his soul to save Crash Simpson, his adoptive father, and becomes the Ghost Rider (*Marvel Spotlight* #5).

- **Robbie Reyes** is killed **by gangsters** while racing his **Charger** for money for **Gabe**, and **comes back as a Ghost Rider** (*All-New Ghost Rider* #1).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| **Johnny's spirit** is **Zarathos** (616 since 1980s) | It's the most famous version. Robbie's spirit is **Eli Morrow**, as in 2014. |

| **Doom watches from a royal box** | It ties the series to *Secret Wars* |

How the violence is handled: TV-MA. **Hellfire, burning bones, and a lot of wrecks.**

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in the series	Held back (why)	Match
Robbie Reyes	Hellfire, supernatural strength, the Hell Charger (a demon car), teleports through its tailpipe ; Eli Morrow's spirit	All of it	—	 100%
Johnny Blaze	The Spirit of Vengeance: hellfire, the Penance Stare (makes the guilty feel every pain they've caused), a hellfire chain, a flaming bike; near-invulnerable	All of it	—	 100%
Danny Ketch	The same Ghost Rider powers, a mystic chain	All of it	—	 100%
Carter Slade	A ghostly gunslinger and a phantom horse	All of it	—	 100%
Alejandra	Ghost Rider powers	All of it	—	 100%
Arcade	A genius engineer of death traps; Murderworld	The whole Killiseum is a trap	—	 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	In Doom's Battleworld, every Ghost Rider who ever lived is chained to a racetrack from hell, and the crowd's new favorite is a kid from East L.A. who never wanted to be a hero.
Theme	Vengeance vs. freedom. The Spirits of Vengeance have been used as entertainment. Now they want something else.
Villain / antagonist	ARCADE (main); God Doom watching

What the season is about

- **Episodes 1–2: The Killiseum.** Every week, **Ghost Riders race to the death.** **Robbie Reyes** is the **champion.** In flashback: **Robbie**, his brother **Gabe**, and **the night he died in his Charger.**
- **Episodes 3–4: Johnny Blaze, the old legend,** is **tired of winning.** His flashback is **Crash Simpson** and **the deal with the devil.** **Danny, Alejandra** and **Carter Slade** join them.
- **Episode 5: "Hellfire Night."** **The Halloween race.** Arcade **changes the rules.** The racers **stop racing each other** and **start protecting each other.**
- **Episodes 6–7: Murderworld.** Arcade throws **every trap he has** at them. **Johnny unleashes Zarathos.**
- **Episode 8: The Ghost Racers rise.** They **turn the Killiseum against Arcade** and **ride out of it together.** **Doom**, from his box, **watches them go.** *"Let them run. There's nowhere to run to."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Battleworld, the Killiseum (Doomstadt, the capital). Monday, June 5 → Saturday, September 30, 2028. Flashbacks: East Los Angeles, 2014 (Robbie); the 1970s (Johnny).
Where it's set	Battleworld: Doomstadt, the Killiseum · the Deadlands' borders
Relative to other films	It runs after <i>Spider-Man: Renew Your Vows</i>. The Life Raft survivors are already awake and in hiding.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The series' own world

- **The Ghost Riders, the Spirits of Vengeance, and Arcade** join the MCU.
- **Doomstadt**, Battleworld's capital, is seen **for the first time**.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Spirits of Vengeance	The finale	The supernatural corner of the MCU after <i>Secret Wars</i>
Robbie Reyes	Leads	Phase 6 and beyond

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom's bread and circuses	The Killiseum	God Doom rules with spectacle and fear
"There's nowhere to run to."	Doom	Battleworld is all that's left

7. POST-CREDIT SCENE (Episode 8)

Field	Entry
Post-credit scene	 "THE STRANGER." The desert outside Doomstadt, at night. The Ghost Racers stop their engines . A figure is sitting by a fire in the road. Johnny Blaze looks closer. It's Peter Parker of Earth-616 , hooded, with Carol Danvers beside him. PETER: "We heard you guys don't like Doom much." ROBBIE: "...Who's asking?" CAROL: "The people who remember what came before."
Secret shoot codename	"ROADSIDE."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scene · [x] The series' own world-building · [x] MCU world-building

· [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · [x] **Episode count, runtimes and release pattern**